

MARUWA (5344.T)

Raising FY3/28-FY3/29E OP/target price on higher AI-related sales estimates; 2Q earnings key to share price performance; reiterate Buy

5344.T

12m Price Target: ¥90,000

Price: ¥53,510

Upside: 68.2%

Our global technology team upwardly revised its global optical transceiver market size forecasts on September 6 ([LINK](#)), mainly to reflect higher AI server shipments and higher usage of optical modules per ASIC/GPU. The team raised its global optical transceiver shipment volume forecasts for 2026-2028 by 21%/31%/31%, and 800G+ shipments by 31%/39%/36%. It now assumes the 800G and above segment will grow at a +69% CAGR from 2026 to 2028.

Based on this, we raise our FY3/28-FY3/29 AI-related sales estimates for MARUWA by 20%/15% to ¥60 bn/¥75 bn (FY3/27E unchanged at ¥32 bn). In line with our increased estimates for AI-related sales, which have a high contribution margin ratio, we raise our FY3/28-FY3/29 operating profit estimates by 10%/6% (FY3/27E unchanged). Furthermore, we raise our 12-month target price, calculated using an EV/EBITDA multiple of 12.6X, to ¥90,000, from ¥89,000, and reiterate our Buy rating.

While 1Q3/27 sales for AI applications were broadly flat qoq, the company is targeting steady sales growth from 2Q. FY3/27 sales guidance for these applications calls for them to more than double yoy to c.¥31 bn, and we assume qoq sales growth, including the Seto No. 2 plant starting to contribute from 3Q. MARUWA also said that **the start of operations at the Seto No. 3 plant could be brought forward to 1H3/28**. We estimate the normal production capacity per plant to be roughly ¥24-25 bn per year, and assume the aforementioned AI-related sales figures for each fiscal year are within an achievable range considering the plant operation schedules. However, as the FY3/29E sales of ¥75 bn would require all 3 announced plants to operate normally, we assume additional production capacity expansion would be necessary from FY3/30.

We think whether MARUWA can achieve implied 2Q3/27 operating profit guidance of ¥8.45 bn will be a key to its share price

BUY

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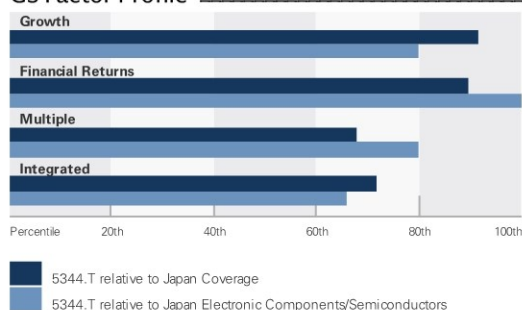
Key Data

Market cap: ¥660.2bn / \$4.2bn
Enterprise value: ¥574.1bn / \$3.7bn
3m ADTV: ¥8.6bn / \$53.3mn
Japan
Japan Electronic Components/Semiconductors
M&A Rank: 3
Leases incl. in net debt & EV?: Yes

GS Forecast

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Revenue (¥ bn)	74.5	93.3	124.0	142.5
Op. profit (¥ bn) New	25.0	35.0	57.0	71.0
Op. profit (¥ bn) Old	25.0	35.0	52.0	67.0
Op. profit CoE (¥ bn)	27.0	33.7	—	—
EPS (¥) New	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,283.7	4,074.1
EPS (¥) Old	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,074.8	3,921.7
P/E (X)	29.0	26.2	16.3	13.1
P/B (X)	3.6	3.9	3.2	2.6
CROCI (%)	18.3	23.7	31.7	34.1
	6/26	9/26E	12/26E	3/27E
EPS (¥)	361.9	456.6	558.7	629.0

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
See disclosures for details.

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BUY

MARUWA (5344.T)

Rating since Apr 3, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

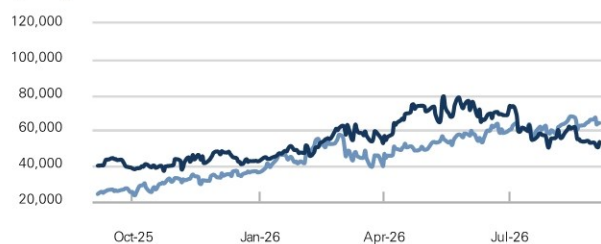
	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
P/E (X)	29.0	26.2	16.3	13.1
P/B (X)	3.6	3.9	3.2	2.6
FCF yield (%)	(1.1)	3.2	4.2	6.0
EV/EBITDAR (X)	15.1	13.7	8.5	6.5
EV/EBITDA (excl. leases) (X)	15.1	13.7	8.5	6.5
CROCI (%)	18.3	23.7	31.7	34.1
ROE (%)	13.2	15.9	21.4	21.7
Net debt/equity (%)	(45.7)	(50.5)	(53.1)	(57.6)
Net debt/equity (excl. leases) (%)	(45.7)	(50.5)	(53.1)	(57.6)
Interest cover (X)	—	—	—	—
Days inventory outst, sales	69.0	52.7	36.6	39.0
Receivable days	64.3	44.2	30.7	32.7
Days payable outstanding	37.3	31.7	27.3	32.7
DuPont ROE (%)	12.3	14.8	19.5	19.8
Turnover (X)	0.5	0.5	0.6	0.5
Leverage (X)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Gross cash invested (ex cash) (¥)	128.8	139.9	160.4	178.8
Average capital employed (¥)	68.1	82.3	91.1	102.8
BVPS (¥)	11,933.9	13,825.3	16,859.0	20,613.1

Growth & Margins (%)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue growth	3.7	25.3	32.9	14.9
EBITDA growth	(4.4)	38.5	53.6	22.5
EPS growth	(5.6)	38.7	60.8	24.1
DPS growth	8.5	47.1	66.7	28.0
EBIT margin	33.5	37.5	46.0	49.8
EBITDA margin	40.7	45.0	52.0	55.4
Net income margin	24.4	27.0	32.7	35.3

Price Performance

5344.T (¥)



	3m	6m	12m
Absolute	(29.7)%	(7.0)%	40.3%
Rel. to the TOPIX	(32.3)%	(17.7)%	5.3%

Source: FactSet. Price as of 4 Sep 2026 close.

Income Statement (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Total revenue	74.5	93.3	124.0	142.5
Cost of goods sold	(35.3)	(40.5)	(43.4)	(44.4)
SG&A	(12.6)	(16.0)	(21.6)	(24.9)
R&D	(1.6)	(1.8)	(2.0)	(2.2)
Other operating inc./exp.)	—	—	—	—
EBITDA	30.3	42.0	64.5	79.0
Depreciation & amortization	(5.3)	(7.0)	(7.5)	(8.0)
EBIT	25.0	35.0	57.0	71.0
Net interest inc./exp.)	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Income/(loss) from associates	—	—	—	—
Pre-tax profit	26.4	36.2	58.2	72.2
Provision for taxes	(8.3)	(11.0)	(17.6)	(21.9)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Preferred dividends	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	18.2	25.2	40.5	50.3
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	18.2	25.2	40.5	50.3
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,283.7	4,074.1
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,283.7	4,074.1
EPS (basic, post-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,283.7	4,074.1
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (¥)	1,471.9	2,041.6	3,283.7	4,074.1
DPS (¥)	102.0	150.0	250.0	320.0
Div. payout ratio (%)	6.9	7.3	7.6	7.9

Balance Sheet (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Cash & cash equivalents	67.2	86.0	110.4	146.4
Accounts receivable	13.7	9.0	11.9	13.7
Inventory	16.3	10.7	14.2	16.3
Other current assets	6.6	6.6	6.6	6.6
Total current assets	103.7	112.2	143.1	182.9
Net PP&E	57.3	70.3	77.8	84.8
Net intangibles	0.4	0.4	0.4	0.4
Total investments	0.1	0.1	0.1	0.1
Other long-term assets	1.2	1.5	1.5	1.5
Total assets	162.7	184.6	222.9	269.8
Accounts payable	4.3	2.8	3.7	4.3
Short-term debt	—	—	—	—
Short-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other current liabilities	10.6	10.6	10.6	10.6
Total current liabilities	14.9	13.4	14.3	14.9
Long-term debt	0.0	0.0	—	—
Long-term lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other long-term liabilities	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Total long-term liabilities	0.6	0.6	0.6	0.6
Total liabilities	15.4	14.0	14.9	15.4
Preferred shares	—	—	—	—
Total common equity	147.3	170.6	208.0	254.4
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Total liabilities & equity	162.7	184.6	222.9	269.8
Net debt, adjusted	(67.3)	(86.1)	(110.5)	(146.5)

Cash Flow (¥ bn)

	3/26	3/27E	3/28E	3/29E
Net income	18.2	25.2	40.5	50.3
D&A add-back	5.3	7.0	7.5	8.0
Minority interest add-back	—	—	—	—
Net (inc)/dec working capital	(4.3)	8.9	(5.5)	(3.3)
Other operating cash flow	(2.3)	—	—	—
Cash flow from operations	16.9	41.1	42.5	54.9
Capital expenditures	(22.5)	(20.0)	(15.0)	(15.0)
Acquisitions	—	—	—	—
Divestitures	0.0	—	—	—
Others	0.7	—	—	—
Cash flow from investing	(21.8)	(20.0)	(15.0)	(15.0)
Repayment of lease liabilities	—	—	—	—
Dividends paid (common & pref)	(1.3)	(1.9)	(3.1)	(3.9)
Inc/(dec) in debt	—	—	—	—
Other financing cash flows	1.5	(0.4)	0.0	0.0
Cash flow from financing	0.2	(2.2)	(3.1)	(3.9)
Total cash flow	(4.6)	18.8	24.4	36.0
Free cash flow	(5.6)	21.1	27.5	39.9

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

performance going forward. Operating profits have continued to miss guidance/consensus over the past few quarters due to factors such as the impact of yields on AI-related products (4Q3/26 and 1Q3/27) and unexpected inventory adjustments for automotive products (2Q3/26). As the company said yield issues for AI-related products have been completely resolved on the production/inventory fronts (LINK), and it expects robust qoq sales growth for semiconductor applications as well (LINK), we believe the true potential of these two applications, which have high contribution margin ratios, will finally be demonstrated. We expect a valuation-driven rise in the share price as the company posts 2Q operating profits in line with market expectations.

Exhibit 1: MARUWA: Earnings summary

(JPY: Bn)	FY3/27				FY3/28			FY3/29		
	GSE		CoE	Bloomberg	GSE		Bloomberg	GSE		Bloomberg
	Old	New			Old	New		Old	New	
Sales	93.3	93.3	93.3	91.3	114.0	124.0	106.8	132.5	142.5	123.0
OP	35.0	35.0	33.7	34.1	52.0	57.0	43.9	67.0	71.0	56.1
NI	25.2	25.2	-	24.5	37.9	40.5	31.6	48.4	50.3	39.2

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research, Bloomberg

Exhibit 2: Trial calculation of P/E based on our FY3/27-FY3/29 estimates

Stock price	51,000	52,000	53,000	54,000	55,000	56,000	57,000	58,000	59,000	60,000	61,000
FY25E PER	34.6x	35.3x	36.0x	36.7x	37.4x	38.0x	38.7x	39.4x	40.1x	40.8x	41.4x
FY26E PER	25.0x	25.5x	26.0x	26.5x	26.9x	27.4x	27.9x	28.4x	28.9x	29.4x	29.9x
FY27E PER	15.5x	15.8x	16.1x	16.4x	16.7x	17.1x	17.4x	17.7x	18.0x	18.3x	18.6x
FY28E PER	12.5x	12.8x	13.0x	13.3x	13.5x	13.7x	14.0x	14.2x	14.5x	14.7x	15.0x

Stock price	62,000	63,000	64,000	65,000	66,000	67,000	68,000	69,000	70,000	71,000	72,000
FY25E PER	42.1x	42.8x	43.5x	44.2x	44.8x	45.5x	46.2x	46.9x	47.6x	48.2x	48.9x
FY26E PER	30.4x	30.9x	31.3x	31.8x	32.3x	32.8x	33.3x	33.8x	34.3x	34.8x	35.3x
FY27E PER	18.9x	19.2x	19.5x	19.8x	20.1x	20.4x	20.7x	21.0x	21.3x	21.6x	21.9x
FY28E PER	15.2x	15.5x	15.7x	16.0x	16.2x	16.4x	16.7x	16.9x	17.2x	17.4x	17.7x

Stock price	73,000	74,000	75,000	76,000	77,000	78,000	79,000	80,000	81,000	82,000	83,000
FY25E PER	49.6x	50.3x	51.0x	51.6x	52.3x	53.0x	53.7x	54.4x	55.0x	55.7x	56.4x
FY26E PER	35.8x	36.2x	36.7x	37.2x	37.7x	38.2x	38.7x	39.2x	39.7x	40.2x	40.7x
FY27E PER	22.2x	22.5x	22.8x	23.1x	23.4x	23.8x	24.1x	24.4x	24.7x	25.0x	25.3x
FY28E PER	17.9x	18.2x	18.4x	18.7x	18.9x	19.1x	19.4x	19.6x	19.9x	20.1x	20.4x

Stock price	84,000	85,000	86,000	87,000	88,000	89,000	90,000	91,000	92,000	93,000	94,000
FY25E PER	57.1x	57.7x	58.4x	59.1x	59.8x	60.5x	61.1x	61.8x	62.5x	63.2x	63.9x
FY26E PER	41.1x	41.6x	42.1x	42.6x	43.1x	43.6x	44.1x	44.6x	45.1x	45.6x	46.0x
FY27E PER	25.6x	25.9x	26.2x	26.5x	26.8x	27.1x	27.4x	27.7x	28.0x	28.3x	28.6x
FY28E PER	20.6x	20.9x	21.1x	21.4x	21.6x	21.8x	22.1x	22.3x	22.6x	22.8x	23.1x

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

MARUWA

Investment Thesis - MARUWA

As a ceramics supplier, MARUWA's history dates back nearly 200 years. The company provides a wide range of ceramic products mainly for applications in fields such as (1) telecommunications, (2) autos, (3) semiconductors, and (4) industrial equipment. MARUWA has been transforming its business portfolio since the mid-2000s, shifting its focus from highly commoditized and cyclical products that face intense price-based competition to high-margin products for niche markets that require customization.

Margins have improved sharply as a result, and MARUWA has won high share in niche markets with strong growth potential. It has established a structural competitive advantage enabling high growth, customization, margins, and market share. In FY3/27-FY3/29, we expect earnings growth to be driven mainly by heat-dissipation substrates for optical transceivers, as well as xEVs and quartz/SiC products for semiconductor production equipment. We are Buy rated on the stock, as we think earnings growth potential from FY3/27 is not fully factored into the current share price.

Price Target Risks and Methodology - MARUWA

We are Buy rated on MARUWA. Our 12-month target price is ¥90,000 (implies FY27/28E P/E of 27x/22x). Our target price is based on FY28E EBITDA, and we derive the applied multiple of 12.6x from the historical correlation between the EBITDA margin and the EV/EBITDA multiple. Key risks include lower investment in applications that support final demand (including AI/general-purpose servers, xEV, SPE), lower demand for end products due to supply chain disruptions and inventory adjustments, and the emergence of alternative technology.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

We, Mitsuhiro Icho and Daiki Takayama, hereby certify that all of the views expressed in this report accurately reflect our personal views about the subject company or companies and its or their securities. We also certify that no part of our compensation was, is or will be, directly or indirectly, related to the specific recommendations or views expressed in this report.

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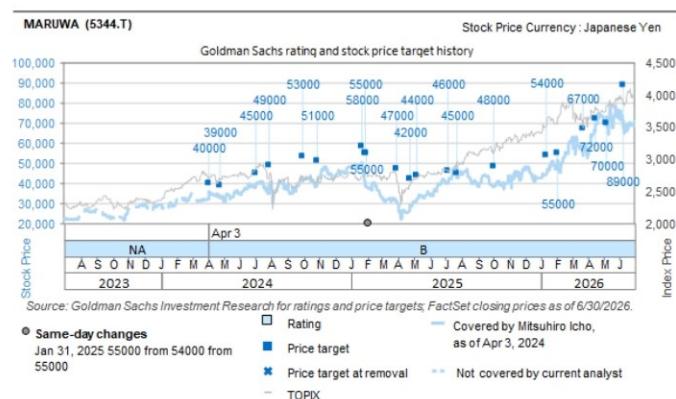
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Global	50%	34%	16%		65%	59%	43%

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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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Target price history table(s)

MARUWA (5344.T)

Date of report Target price (¥) Closing price (¥)

08-Jun-26	89,000	67,750
08-May-26	70,000	68,930
16-Apr-26	72,000	69,200
23-Mar-26	67,000	53,790
03-Feb-26	55,000	51,620
12-Jan-26	54,000	44,550
02-Oct-25	48,000	38,170
24-Jul-25	45,000	46,930
07-Jul-25	46,000	40,020
08-May-25	44,000	32,210
25-Apr-25	42,000	29,375
31-Mar-25	47,000	30,320
01-Feb-25	55,000	38,320
31-Jan-25	54,000	38,320
29-Jan-25	55,000	40,900
22-Jan-25	58,000	50,150
29-Oct-24	51,000	41,650
01-Oct-24	53,000	43,300
29-Jul-24	49,000	40,500
02-Jul-24	45,000	38,300
25-Apr-24	39,000	33,300
03-Apr-24	40,000	32,350

Price targets shown in table(s) are unadjusted for corporate actions.

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